

Standup 1: Project Kickoff and Problem Definition

During the first week, I formally initiated the project and focused on clearly defining the problem statement. The goal was to understand how behavioral, demographic, and financial factors collectively influence credit scores, which directly affect access to housing, loans, and employment opportunities. Rather than focusing only on income, the project aimed to examine broader behavioral indicators such as payment delays, credit utilization, and inquiry frequency.

The primary challenge at this stage was controlling scope. Many potentially interesting angles emerged early, but pursuing all of them would have diluted the analysis. I addressed this by narrowing the focus to five clearly defined research questions, establishing a structured direction for the project.

In the upcoming week, I plan to conduct a targeted literature review to ground the project in existing research. Documentation will capture early assumptions, rationale for scope decisions, and preliminary notes in a version-controlled format.